

“IS THERE NOT A CAUSE”

TEXT: 1 Samuel 17:19-31 *“Now Saul, and they, and all the men of Israel, were in the valley of Elah, fighting with the Philistines.*

²⁰And David rose up early in the morning, and left the sheep with a keeper, and took, and went, as Jesse had commanded him; and he came to the trench, as the host was going forth to the fight, and shouted for the battle.

²¹For Israel and the Philistines had put the battle in array, army against army. ²²And David left his carriage in the hand of the keeper of the carriage, and ran into the army, and came and saluted his brethren. ²³And as he talked with them, behold, there came up the champion, the Philistine of Gath, Goliath by name, out of the armies of the Philistines, and spake according to the same words: and David heard them. ²⁴And all the men of Israel, when they saw the man, fled from him, and were sore afraid. ²⁵And the men of Israel said, Have ye seen this man that is come up? surely to defy Israel is he come up: and it shall be, that the man who killeth him, the king will enrich him with great riches, and will give him his daughter, and make his father's house free in Israel. ²⁶And David spake to the men that stood by him, saying, What shall be done to the man that killeth this Philistine, and taketh away the reproach from Israel? for who is this uncircumcised Philistine, that he should defy the armies of the living God? ²⁷And the people answered him after this manner, saying, So shall it be done to the man that killeth him.

²⁸And Eliab his eldest brother heard when he spake unto the men; and Eliab's anger was kindled against David, and he said, Why camest thou down hither? and with whom hast thou left those few sheep in the wilderness? I know thy pride, and the naughtiness of thine heart; for thou art come down that thou mightest see the battle. ²⁹And David said, What have I now done? Is there not a cause? ³⁰And he turned from him toward another, and spake after the same manner: and the people answered him again after the former manner. ³¹And when the words were heard which David spake, they rehearsed them before Saul: and he sent for him.”

INTRO: (History of this scripture) David is the youngest of the eight sons of Jesse. Nathan the prophet has already been to Jesse's house to anoint a King. David has killed a bear and a lion without the advantage of weapons!

David has three older brothers, Eliab, Abinadab, and Shamma, who are soldiers in Saul's army. David's brothers were no doubt his heroes! He

probably dreamed of the day that he would grow up to be a brave soldier, just like them!

The Philistines have attacked Israel and Jesse sends David to the war zone to check on his brothers.

When David get's to the battlefield he see's Goliath defying the armies of God! Goliath was 9'9" tall his armor weighed in at nearly 200 lb..

For the first time in his life David see's his brothers for what they really are! **COWARDS!!!**

David begins inquiring as to what will happen to the man who kills the giant! He is told that he will be enriched with great riches, his house will be forever free in Israel, and he would be allowed to marry the King's daughter!

David is discouraged by his brothers! (Who did you leave those **FEW SHEEP** with?)

I. NOTICE DAVID HAD A CAUSE!!!

A. 1 Samuel 17:29 *"And David said, What have I now done? Is there not a cause?"*

I want to ask you, do we **"HAVE A CAUSE?"**

More than half of the world's population will go to bed hungry tonight. Do we **"HAVE A CAUSE?"**

B. David did not allow Eliab's words to discourage him, and he refused to allow fear of failure to dominate his life!

David was summoned to Saul's presence and was told that he was not man enough to do the Job!

Notice David's response **1 Samuel 17:32** *"And David said to Saul, Let no man's heart fail because of him; thy servant will go and fight with this Philistine."*

Just because David did not allow fear of failure to rule his life, didn't mean that there were no Giants!

C. Just because there was a lack of fear didn't mean that there would be no battle!!!

1 Samuel 17:42-44 *"And when the Philistine looked about, and saw David, he disdained him: for he was but a youth, and ruddy, and of a fair countenance. ⁴³And the Philistine said unto David, Am I a dog, that thou comest to me with staves? And the Philistine cursed David by his gods. ⁴⁴And the Philistine said to David, Come to me, and I will give thy flesh unto the fowls of the air, and to the beasts of the field."*

Just because we have become a Church that has decided to overcome the fear of failure in the area of fulfilling the great commission, does not mean there will be no giants, or battles!

Goliath did not roll over and play dead just because David came out there with a sling shot and a shepherds bag!

The devil is not going to play dead just because we have decided to feed the hungry, clothe the naked, shelter the homeless, heal the sick, encourage the destitute, and preach the Gospel to those who have never heard!

In fact it affects him just as word of David's challenge affected Goliath, it **"DISDAINS"** him!

Makes him mad! Burns him up! Ticks him off!

I have a question, **"DO WE HAVE A CAUSE?"**

II. CHRIST HAD A CAUSE!!!

A. Jesus talking to the Greeks who came to Philip desiring to see Jesus says in **John 12:27**

"Now is my soul troubled; and what shall I say? Father, save me from this hour: but for this cause came I unto this hour."

B. Notice the words of Jesus while being interviewed by Pilate in **John 18:37** *"Pilate therefore said unto him, Art thou a king then? Jesus*

answered, Thou sayest that I am a king. To this end was I born, and for this cause came I into the world, that I should bear witness unto the truth. Every one that is of the truth heareth my voice."

C. Paul makes this statement to Timothy about Jesus, **1 Tim. 1:15** *"This is a faithful saying, and worthy of all acceptation, that Christ Jesus came into the world to save sinners; of whom I am chief."*

III. CHURCH WE HAVE A CAUSE!!!

A. The great Commission! **Mark 16:15** *"And he said unto them, Go ye into all the world, and preach the gospel to every creature."*

B. Church, we have been commanded to reach this lost and dying world, but we were not promised that there would be no giants or battles!!!

In fact quite the contrary is true! **Ephes. 6:12** *"For we wrestle not against flesh and blood, but against principalities, against powers, against the rulers of the darkness of this world, against spiritual wickedness in high places."*

We **"HAVE A CAUSE"**! 3.5 Billion people without an adequate witness of Christ! More than half of the worlds population will go to bed hungry tonight!

C. Just knowing about our **"CAUSE"**, and the need that is present will not be enough!

We **MUST** get to work, and pool our resources to **SEND THE LIGHT!**

D. If we will be willing to do the job, Christ has promised that he would empower us so that we will be effective! **Acts 1:8** *"But ye shall receive power, after that the Holy Ghost is come upon you: and ye shall be witnesses unto me both in Jerusalem, and in all Judaea, and in Samaria, and unto the uttermost part of the earth."*

You may ask, preacher can we at Malvern really effect a change in our community, and around the world?

Let me just put it like this, if we will work, and pray, and give in the power of the Holy Spirit we **CAN** and **WILL** make a difference!

1 Samuel 17:45-51 *"Then said David to the Philistine, Thou comest to me with a sword, and with a spear, and with a shield: but I come to thee in the name of the Lord of hosts, the God of the armies of Israel, whom*

thou hast defied. ⁴⁶This day will the Lord deliver thee into mine hand; and I will smite thee, and take thine head from thee; and I will give the carcases of the host of the Philistines this day unto the fowls of the air, and to the wild beasts of the earth; that all the earth may know that there is a God in Israel. ⁴⁷And all this assembly shall know that the Lord saveth not with sword and spear: for the battle is the Lord's, and he will give you into our hands. ⁴⁸And it came to pass, when the Philistine arose, and came and drew nigh to meet David, that David hasted, and ran toward the army to meet the Philistine. ⁴⁹And David put his hand in his bag, and took thence a stone, and slang it, and smote the Philistine in his forehead, that the stone sunk into his forehead; and he fell upon his face to the earth. ⁵⁰So David prevailed over the Philistine with a sling and with a stone, and smote the Philistine, and slew him; but there was no sword in the hand of David. ⁵¹Therefore David ran, and stood upon the Philistine, and took his sword, and drew it out of the sheath thereof, and slew him, and cut off his head therewith. And when the Philistines saw their champion was dead, they fled."

David won the battle, and so will we, it was a no brainer!

MISSION ACCOMPLISHED!!!

